

## *Dedication*

To all the English language learners out there, this textbook is dedicated to you. I understand that learning a new language can be a challenging and rewarding journey, and I hope that this book will serve as a valuable resource in your pursuit of proficiency. I believe that a strong command of English can open up new doors and opportunities in both personal and professional contexts. With this in mind, I dedicate my efforts to helping you achieve your language goals and succeed in your endeavors.

## *Preface*

As English continues to grow as a global language, the need for clear and effective communication has never been greater. This textbook aims to help learners of English develop their language skills in a comprehensive and engaging way. Whether you are a beginner or an advanced learner, this book will guide you through the fundamental rules of grammar and usage, while providing practical examples and exercises to reinforce your understanding.

I understand that learning a new language can be a daunting task, and that's why we have designed this book to be as user-friendly as possible. Each chapter builds upon the previous one, gradually introducing new concepts and structures, and providing ample opportunities for practice and review. Throughout the development of this textbook, I have drawn upon the expertise of experienced language teachers, linguists, and writers to ensure the accuracy and relevance of the content. However, we recognize that no book can substitute for the guidance and support of a qualified instructor, and I encourage learners to seek out such resources wherever possible.

In conclusion, I hope that this textbook will be a valuable tool for anyone looking to improve their English skills, whether for academic, professional, or personal purposes. I welcome your feedback and suggestions for future editions, and wish you all the best in your language learning journey.

**TEACH YOURSELF ENGLISH**

*A comprehensive guide to English Fluency*

SERIES 2

*by*

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## CHAPTER ONE

### 400 + IDIOMS TO EXPECT IN UTME EXAM

It is imperative for candidates sitting for JAMB CBT and POST-UTME examination to have a requisite knowledge about Idioms. We advise candidates to read through this Idioms and their meaning. What is an Idiom?

Idioms are words, phrases, or expressions that cannot be taken literally. In other words, when used in everyday language, they have a meaning other than the basic one you would find in the dictionary. Every language has its own idioms. Learning them makes understanding and using a language a lot easier and more fun!

For example, "break a leg" is a common idiom.

**Literal meaning:** I command you to break a bone in your leg and you should probably go to the doctor afterwards to get it fixed.

**Idiomatic meaning:** Do your best and do well. Often, actors tell each other to "break a leg" before they go out on stage to perform.

**Here are the idioms and their complete meaning.**

**A big cheese** - an important or a powerful person in a group or family

**A bird's eye view** - a view from a very high place which allows you to see a large area

**A bone of contention** - something that people argue for a long time

**A cock and a bull story** - a story or an explanation which is obviously not true.

**At the crack of the dawn** - very early in morning

**A cuckoo in the nest** - someone in a group of people but not liked by them.

**A litmus test** - a method which clearly proves something

**As the crow flies** - measuring distance between two places in a straight

**A dead letter** - an argument or law not followed by anyone.

**At the drop of the hat** - you do something easily and without any preparation

**An early bird** - someone who gets early in the morning

**An educated guess** - a guess which was likely to get corrected

**At the eleventh hour** - be too late. A queer fish - a strange person

**A wakeup call** - an event done to warn someone

**A worm's eye view** - having very little knowledge about something

**A witch hunt** - an attempt to find and punish those who have options that are believed to be dangerous

**At the heels of** - to follow someone

**A dish fit for Gods** - something of very high quality

**A game of two equal halves** - a sudden change in circumstances

**Afraid of one's own shadow** - to become easily frightened

**Against the clock** - to be in a hurry to do something before a particular time

**Air one's dirty laundry** - to make public something embarrassing that should be kept secret.

**All systems go** - everything is ready.

**An arm and a leg** - a large amount of money

**Appear out of now here** - to appear suddenly without warning.

**Apple of someone's eye** - someone loved very much.

**Ask for the moon** - to ask for too much.

**Asleep at the switch** - not to be alert on opportunity

**At sixes and sevens** - to be lost and bewildered

**At someone's beck and call** - to be always ready to serve

**At the bottom of the ladder** - at the lowest level

**A house of cards** - a poor plan

**At an arm's length** - to keep at a distance

**At sixes and sevens** - in disorder

**A boon in disguise** - a benefit in loss

**A bull in a China shop** - an awkward person

**A red letter day** - an important day

**A nine days wonder** - pleasure for a short time  
**A bit under the weather** - falling ill  
**Bad blood**- feelings of hate between two families  
**Bend your ears**- to talk to someone for a very long time about something boring  
**Bite your tongue**- to stop yourself from saying something because it would be better not to  
**Black and blue**- full of bruises  
**Blue blood**- belonging to high social class  
**Be above board**- to be honest and legal  
**Be bouncing off the walls**- excited and full of nervous energy  
**Brass monkey weather**- extremely cold weather  
**Be tailor made**- to be completely suitable for someone.  
**Break the ice**- to make more comfort or relaxed with a person whom you have not met earlier, to break the silence  
**Be as clear as mud**- to be impossible to understand  
**Be on cloud nine**- be very happy  
**Between the devil and deep blue sea**- a type of situation where u must choose between two equally unpleasant situations  
**Be in the doldrums**- not very successful or nothing new is taking place  
**Beat the drum**- to speak eagerly about something you support  
**Be on the edge**- to be nervous or worried about something  
**Be in seventh heaven**- extremely happy  
**Be at each other's throat**- two persons arguing angrily  
**Batten down the hatches**- to prepare for trouble  
**Back the wrong horse**- to support someone weak  
**Back to square one**- to reach again to the starting point  
**Back to the salt mines**- back to something that you don't want to do  
**Ball of fire**- active and energetic  
**Beat one's head against the wall**- to try to do something that is hopeless  
**Bark up the wrong tree**- to make a wrong assumption  
**Batten down the hatches**- prepare for difficult times  
**Beat one's brain out**- to work hard

**Begin to see the light**- to begin to understand  
**Behind closed doors**- done in secret  
**Bet on the wrong horse**- to misread the future  
**Bent on doing**- to be determined to do something  
**Bite off more than one can chew**- to do more than one's ability  
**Bite the bullet**- to face a difficult situation bravely  
**Bitter pill to swallow**- an unpleasant fact that must be accepted  
**Black sheep of the family**- worst member  
**Blessing in disguise**- something that turns out to be good which earlier appeared to be wrong  
**Blind leading the blind**- someone who does not understand something but tries to explain it to other  
**Blow one's own horn**- to praise one  
**Blow someone's mind**- excite someone  
**Bone of contention**- subject matter of the fight  
**Bring home the bacon**- to earn money to live  
**Blue in the face**- exhausted and speechless  
**Break the back of**- reduce the power of something  
**Burn a hole in one's pocket**- to spend money quickly  
**Burn the midnight oil**- to study till late of night  
**Bushman's holiday**- a holiday where you spend doing same thing as you did at working days  
**Button's one lip**- to keep quite  
**Reak a leg**- to wish good luck  
**Carrot and sticks**- You use both awards as well as punishments to make someone do something.  
**Cloak and dragger**- when people behave in a very secret manner  
**Cards are stacked against**- luck is against you  
**Crack a book**- to open book to study  
**Cross a bridge before one comes to it**- worry about the future in advance  
**Carry coals to new castle**- to take something to a place or a person that has a lot of that thing already

**Cast in the same mould-** to be very similar

**Change horses in midstream-** to change plans

**Cap it all-** to finish

**Cried with eyes out-** cried a lot

**Carry the can-** If you carry the can, you take the blame for something, even though you didn't do it or are only partly at fault.

**Cast a long shadow-** Something or someone that casts a long shadow has considerable influence on other people or events.

**Cat and dog life-** If people lead a cat and dog life, they are always arguing.

**Drive a wedge between-** to break relationship between the two

**Dances to the tune-** to always do what someone tells you to do

**Dressed up to the nines-** wearing fancy clothes

**Dragging its feet-** delaying in decision, not showing enthusiasm

**Davey Jones' locker-** Davey Jones' locker is the bottom of the sea or resting place of drowned sailors. ('Davy Jones' locker' is an alternative spelling.)

**Dancing on someone's grave-** If you will dance on someone's grave, you will outlive or Outlast them and will celebrate their demise

**Dog in the manger-** If someone acts like a dog in the manger, they don't want other people to have or enjoy things that are useless to them

**Don't cry over spilt milk-** When something bad happens and nothing can be done to help it people say, 'Don't cry over spilt milk'

**Don't wash your dirty laundry in public-** People, especially couples, who argue in front of others or involve others in their personal problems and crises, are said to be washing their dirty laundry in public; making public things that are best left private.

**Donkey work-** Donkey work is any hard, boring work or task.  
Don't throw bricks when you live in a glass house- Don't call others out on actions that you, yourself do. Don't be a hypocrite.

**Entering the 80th orbit-** celebrating the 80th birthday

**Eleventh hour decision-** decision that is made at the last possible minute

**End in smoke-** to bear no result

**Earth shattering-** not at all surprising

**Eat humble pie-** to apologize humbly

**Elephant in the room-** An elephant in the room is a problem that everyone knows very well but no one talks about because it is taboo, embarrassing, etc.

**Egg on your face-** If someone has egg on their face; they are made to look foolish or embarrassed

**Eye for an eye-** This is an expression for retributive justice, where the punishment equals the crime.

**Eyes are bigger than one's stomach-** If someone's eyes are bigger than their stomach, they are greedy and take on more than they can consume or manage.

**From cradle to grave-** during the whole span of your life.

**Face the music-** to accept punishment for something you have done.

**Feel the pinch-** to have problems with money.

**Fall on your own sword-** to be cheated by someone you trust.

**Feather in one's cap-** something that you achieve and proud of.

**Firing on all cylinders-** work every possible way to succeed.

**French leave-** absent without permission, to take French leave is to leave a gathering without saying goodbye or without permission.

**Fall on our feet-** If you fall on your feet, you succeed in doing something where there was a risk of failure.

**Fall on your sword-** If someone falls on their sword, they resign or accept the consequences of what they have done wrong.

**Fingers and thumbs-** If you are all fingers and thumbs, you are being clumsy and not very skilled with your hands.

**Finger in the pie-** If you have a finger in the pie, you have an interest in something.

**Flash in the pan-** If something is a flash in the pan; it is very noticeable but doesn't last long, like most singers, who are very successful for a while, then forgotten.

**Follow your nose-** When giving directions, telling someone to follow their nose means that they should go straight ahead.

**Fool's paradise-** A fool's paradise is a false sense of happiness or success

**Foot in mouth-** This is used to describe someone who has just said something Embarrassing, inappropriate, wrong or stupid

**For a song-** If you buy or sell something for a song, it is very cheap

**For donkey's years-** If people have done something, usually without much if any

**Get off the hook-** free from all obligations

**Give-up the ghost-** to die

**Got the slap on the wrist-** got light punishment

**Give someone a bird-** make fun

**Got the wind up-** to be scared

**Get a raw deal-** not treated equally

**Gift of the gab-** talent of speaking, if someone has the gift of the gab, they speak in a persuasive and interesting way  
- to ignore

**Get your wires crossed-** If people get their wires cross, they misunderstand each other, especially when making arrangements. ('Get your lines crossed' is also used.)

**Give me five-** If someone says this, they want to hit your open hand against theirs as a  
Way of congratulation or greeting

**Give me a hand-** If someone gives you a hand, they help you

**Give someone a piece of your mind-** If you give someone a piece of your mind, you criticize them strongly and angrily.

**Go bananas-** If you go bananas, you are wild with excitement, anxiety, or worry

**Go tell it to birds-** This is used when someone says something that is not credible or is a lie

**Go under the hammer-** If something goes under the hammer, it is sold in an auction

**Graveyard shift-** If you have to work very late at night, it is the graveyard shift

**Grease monkey-** A grease monkey is an idiomatic term for a mechanic

**Have ants in your pants-** not be able to keep still because you are very excited or worried about something.

**Having a whole of a time-** to enjoy very much

**Hold one's horse-** be patient

**Have a big mouth-** one who gossips more or tells secret

**Himalayan blunder-** a serious mistake

**Have a one track mind-** think only of one thing

**Have clean hands-** be guiltless

**Have an egg on the face-** be embarrassed

**Have eyes bigger than stomach-** desiring more food than one can eat

**Heart missed a beat-** very excited

**Heart in the right place-** good natured

**Hit the nail on the head-** done the thing correctly

**Hand to mouth-** Someone who's living from hand to mouth, is very poor and needs the little money they have coming in to cover their expenses

**Have no truck with-** If you have no truck with something or someone, you refuse to get involved with it or them

**Hit the bull's-eye-** If someone hits the bull's-eye, they are exactly right about something or achieve the best result possible.

**Hold water-** When you say that something does or does not 'hold water', it means that the point of view or argument put forward is or is not sound, strong or logical. For e.g. 'Saying we should increase our interest rates because everyone else is doing so will not hold water'

**Hornets' nest-** A hornets' nest is a violent situation or one with a lot of dispute. (If you create the problem, you 'stir up a hornets' nest'.)

**In dribs and drabs-** in small amounts at a time

**In black and white-** to give in writing

**In the blues-** low spirited

**In cahoots with-** in a partnership usually for a dishonest reason

**If the shoe fits, wear it-** This is used to suggest that something that has been said might apply to a person

**In droves**- When things happen in droves, a lot happen at the same time or very quickly

**In the doghouse**- If someone is in the doghouse, they are in disgrace and very Unpopular at the moment.

**Jack Frost** – If everything has frozen in winter, then Jack Frost has visited.

**Jack the Lad** – A confident and not very serious young man who behaves as he wants to without thinking about other people is a Jack the Lad.

**Jack-of-all-trades**- A jack-of-all-trades is someone that can do many different jobs.

**Jam on your face** - If you say that someone has jam on their face, they appear to be caught, embarrassed or found guilty.

**Jam tomorrow** – This idiom is used when people promise good things for the future that will never come.

**Jane Doe** – Jane Doe is a name given to an unidentified female who may be party to legal proceedings, or to an unidentified person in hospital, or dead. John Doe is the male equivalent.

**Jekyll and Hyde** - Someone who has a Jekyll and Hyde personality has a pleasant and a very unpleasant side to the character.

**Jersey justice** – Jersey justice is very severe justice.

**Jet set** - Very wealthy people who travel around the world to attend parties or functions are the jet set.

**Jet-black** - To emphasis just how black something is, such as someone's hair, we can call it jet-black.

**Job's comforter** – Someone who says they want to comfort, but actually discomforts people is a Job's comforter.

**Jobs for the boys** - Where people give jobs, contracts, etc, to their friends and associates, these are jobs for the boys.

**Jockey for position** – If a number of people want the same opportunity and are struggling to emerge as the most likely candidate, they are jockeying for position.

**Jog my memory**- If you jog someone's memory, you say words that will help someone trying to remember a thought, event, word, phrase, experience, etc.

**John Doe**- John Doe is a name given to an unidentified male who may be party to legal proceedings, or to an unidentified person in hospital, or dead. Jane Doe is the female equivalent.

**Joe Public** – Joe Public is the typical, average person.

**Johnny on the spot** - A person who is always available; ready, willing, and able to do what needs to be done. ('Johnny-on-the-spot' is also used.)

**Johnny-come-lately** – A Johnny-come-lately is someone who has recently joined something or arrived somewhere, especially when they want to make changes that are not welcome.

**Join the club** - Said when someone has expressed a desire or opinion, meaning "That viewpoint is not unique to you". It can suggest that the speaker should stop complaining since many others are in the same position. Example: "If this train doesn't come, I'll be late for work!" "Join the club!"

**Joined at the hip** – If people are joined at the hip, they are very closely connected and think the same way.

**Judge, jury and executioner** – If someone is said to be the judge, jury, and executioner, it means they are in charge of every decision made, and they have the power to be rid of whomever they choose.

**Juggle frogs** – If you are juggling frogs, you are trying to do something very difficult.

**Jump down someone's throat** - If you jump down someone's throat, you criticise or chastise them severely.

**Jump on the bandwagon** – If people jump on the bandwagon, they get involved in something that has recently become very popular.

**Jump ship** - If you leave a company or institution for another because it is doing badly, you are jumping ship.

**Jump the broom** – To jump the broom is to marry. (Jump over the broom, jump over the broomstick, jump the broomstick are also used.)

**Jump the gun** - If you jump the gun, you start doing something before the appropriate time.

**Jump the track** - Jumping the track is suddenly changing from one plan, activity, idea, etc, to another.

**Jump through hoops** – If you are prepared to jump through hoops for someone, you are prepared to make great efforts and sacrifices for them.

**Jump to a conclusion** – If someone jumps to a conclusion, they evaluate or judge something without a sufficient examination of the facts.

**Jumping Judas!** - An expression of surprise or shock.

**Jungle out there** - If someone says that it is a jungle out there, they mean that the situation is dangerous and there are no rules.

**Jury's out** - If the jury's out on an issue, then there is no general agreement or consensus on it.

**Just around the corner** - If something is just around the corner, then it is expected to happen very soon.

**Just coming up to** – If the time is just coming up to nine o'clock, it means that it will be nine o'clock in a very few seconds. You'll hear them say it on the radio in the morning.

**Just deserts** - If a bad or evil person gets their just deserts, they get the punishment or suffer the misfortune that it is felt they deserve.

**Just for the heck of it** – When someone does something just for the heck of it, they do it without a good reason.

**Just for the record** - If something is said to be just for the record, the person is saying it so that people know but does not necessarily agree with or support it.

**Just in the nick of time** – If you do something in the nick of time, you just manage to do it just in time, with seconds to spare.

**Just off the boat** - If someone is just off the boat, they are naive and inexperienced.

**Just what the doctor ordered** - If something's just what the doctor ordered, it is precisely what is needed.

**Justice is blind** - Justice is blind means that justice is impartial and objective.

**Kick up a row** - to start a fight, to create disturbance

**Keep ones eye on the ball** - be ready for something

**Kangaroo court** - When people take the law into their own hands and form courts that are not legal, these are known as kangaroo court

**Keep body and soul together** - If you earn enough to cover your basic expenses, but nothing more than that, you earn enough to keep body and soul together.

**Keep your eye on the ball** - If you keep your eye on the ball, you stay alert and pay close attention to what is happening

**Know which way the wind blows** - This means that you should know how things are developing and be prepared for the future.

**Loaves and fishes** - done for material benefits

**Like a shag on a rock** - completely alone.

**Let someone slide** - neglect something

**Let the cat out of the bag** - reveal the secret

**Let nature take its course** - to allow someone to live or die naturally.

**Like a sitting duck** - totally unaware

**Lion's share** - a major share

**Left to your own devices** - If someone is left to their own devices, they are not controlled and can do whatever they want

**Make castles in the air** - plans or hopes that have very little chances of happening.

**Make a bee line for** - to go directly towards something.

**Make ones bed and lie on it** - to be responsible for what you have done and accept the results

**Meet ones Waterloo** - meet ones final end

**Monkey around** - to waste time here and there

**My hands are full** - I am busy

**Make a dry face** - show disappointment

**Make a monkey of someone** - If you make a monkey of someone, you make them look foolish

**Man of his word** - A man of his word is a person who does what he says and keeps his promises

**Many moons ago** - A very long time ago

**Nobody's fool** - one who can take care of himself

**not having a leg to stand for** - not having proof

**Never-never land** - ideal best place.

**No love lost between** - dislike

**Needle in a haystack** - If trying to find something is like looking for a needle in a haystack, it means that it is very difficult, if not impossible to find among everything around it

**New brush sweeps clean-** 'A new brush sweeps clean' means that someone with a new perspective can make great changes. However, the full version is 'a new brush sweeps clean, but an old brush knows the corners', which warns that experience is also a valuable thing

**No smoke without fire-** This idiom means that when people suspect something, there is Normally a good reason for the suspicion, even if there is no concrete evidence. ('Where's there's smoke, there's fire' is a also used.)

**Once in a blue moon-** very rarely

**On the bandwagon-** doing something because others are also doing it

**Open Pandora's box-** to discover more problems

**Over the moon-** being too happy

**On its last legs-** in a bad condition and will not last long

**Old flames die hard-** It's very difficult to forget old things

**On pins and needles-** If you are on pins and needles, you are very worried about something

**On the carpet-** When you are called to the bosses office (since supposedly, they are the only ones who have carpet) and its definitely not for a good reason, i.e., you are in trouble, something has not gone according to plan and either maybe you are responsible and/or have some explaining to do

**On the hook-** If someone is on the hook, they are responsible for something.

**Only the wearer knows where the shoe pinches-** This means that it's hard to know how much someone else is suffering.

**Pass muster-** to be approved

**Pick someone to pieces-** to criticize sharply

**Paper over the cracks-** to try to hide something

**Pull up the shocks-** do things in the right manner and correctly

**Parrot fashion-** If you learn something parrots fashion; you learn it word for word

**Pay on the nail-** If you pay on the nail, you pay promptly in cash

**Pen is mightier than the sword-** The idiom 'the pen is mightier than the sword' means that words and communication are more powerful than wars and fighting

**Pick someone's brains-** If you pick someone's brains, you ask them for advice, Suggestions and information about something they know about

**Pieces of the same cake-** Pieces of the same cake are things that have the same Characteristics or qualities

**Play fast and loose-** If people play fast and loose, they behave in an irresponsible way And don't respect rules, etc.

**Poker face-** Someone with a poker face doesn't show any emotion or reaction so that People don't know what they are feeling

**Quarrel with bread and butter-** Bread and butter, here, indicate the means of one's living. If a sub-ordinate in an organization is quarrelsome or if he is not patient enough to bear the reprimand he deserves, gets angry and retorts or provokes the higher-up, the top man dismisses him from the job. So, he loses the job that gave him bread and butter. Hence we say, he quarreled with bread and butter (manager or the top man) and lost his job

**Quiet as a cat-** If somebody is as quiet as a cat they make as little noise as possible and try to be unnoticeable

**Quiet as a mouse-** If someone's as quiet as a mouse, they make absolutely no noise

**Queer fish-** A strange person is a queer fish

**Rain on your parade-** If someone rains on your parade, they ruin your pleasure or

**Rake someone over the coals-** If you rake someone over the coals, you criticize or scold them severely

**Recipe for disaster-** A recipe for disaster is a mixture of people and events that could only possibly result in trouble

**Red carpet-** If you give someone the red-carpet treatment, you give them a special Welcome to show that you think they are important

**Red herring-** If something is a distraction from the real issues, it is a red herring

**Red letter day-** A red letter day is a one of good luck, when something special happens to you

**Reduce to ashes-** If something is reduced to ashes, it is destroyed or made useless. His infidelities reduced their relationship to ashes

**Round the houses-** If you go round the houses, you do something in an inefficient way when there is a quicker, more convenient way

**Rub shoulders-** If you rub shoulders with people, you meet and spend time with them, Especially when they are powerful or famous

**Run into the sand-** If something runs into the sand, it fails to achieve a result

**Salt on the earth-** fundamental good people

**Sands of time-** tiny amounts of time

**Shake a leg-** to go fast, hurry

**Spill the beans-** to expose a secret

**Snake in the grass-** a hidden army

**Salt on the earth-** fundamental good people

**Sands of time-** tiny amounts of time

**Shake a leg-** to go fast, hurry

**Spill the beans-** to expose a secret

**Snake in the grass-** a hidden army

**Snake in the shoes-** to be in a state of fear

**Stood to his guns-** maintained to his opinion

**showing the door-** asking someone to leave

**Song and a dance-** an excuse

**Salad days-** Your salad days are an especially happy period of your life

**Sail under false colors-** Someone who sails under false colors is hypocritical or Pretends to be something they aren't in order to deceive people

**Threaded his way out-** walked carefully through

**Take the cloth-** to become a priest.

**Talk turkey-** to discuss a problem with a real intension to solve it.

**Tit for tat-** an action done to revenge against a person who has done some wrong to you

**To crow over-** to triumph over someone

**To blow a fuse-** to turn someone angry

**through thick and thin-** under all conditions

**To bell the cat-** to take great risks

**To look through colored glasses-** to look the things not as they are

**Taking to a brick wall-** taking with a no response

**Turned a deaf ear-** disregarded

**Take a back seat-** choose to decrease involvement

**Tables are turned-** When the tables are turned, the situation has changed giving the advantage to the party who had previously been at a disadvantage

**Take someone under your wing-** If you take someone under your wing, you look after them while they are learning something

**Take your medicine-** If you take your medicine, you accept the consequences of something you have done wrong

**Talking to a brick wall-** If you talk to someone and they do not listen to you, it is like talking to a brick wall

**Taste of your own medicine-** If you give someone a taste of their own medicine, you do something bad to someone that they have done to you to teach them a lesson

**The apple does not fall far from the tree-** Offspring grow up to be like their parents

**Through thick and thin-** If someone supports you through thick and thin, they support you during good times and bad

**Upset the apple cart-** to create difficulty

**Under a cloud-** If someone is suspected of having done something wrong, they are under a cloud

**Under fire-** If someone is being attacked and criticized heavily, they are under fire

**Under your nose-** If something happens right in front of you, especially if it is surprising or audacious, it happens under your nose

**Up for grabs-** If something is up for grabs, it is available and whoever is first or is successful will get it

**Up to the neck-** If someone's in something up to the neck, they are very involved in it, especially when it's something wrong

**Up a river without a paddle-** If you up a river without a paddle, you are in an unfortunate situation, unprepared and with none of the resources to remedy the matter

**Uncharted waters-** If you're in uncharted waters, you are in a situation that is unfamiliar to you, that you have no experience of and don't know what might happen

**Under lock and key-** If something is under lock and key, it is stored very securely

**Vale of tears-** This vale of tears is the world and the suffering that life brings.

**Velvet glove -** This idiom is used to describe a person who appears gentle, but is determined and inflexible underneath. ('Iron fist in a velvet glove' is the full form.)

**Vent your spleen –** If someone vents their spleen, they release all their anger about something.

**Vicar of Bray –** A person who changes their beliefs and principles to stay popular with people above them is a Vicar of Bray

**Vicious circle -** A vicious circle is a sequence of events that make each other worse- someone drinks because they are unhappy at work, then loses their job... 'Vicious cycle' is also used.

**Vinegar tits –** A mean spirited women lacking in love or compassion.

**Virgin territory -** If something is virgin territory, it hasn't been explored before.

**Voice in the wilderness –** Someone who expresses an opinion that no one believes or listens to is a voice in the wilderness, especially if proved right later.

**Volt- face -** If you do a volte-face on something, you make a sudden and complete change in your stance or position over an issue.

**Vultures are circling -** If the vultures are circling, then something is in danger and its enemies are getting ready for the kill.

**Weight one's word-** be careful to what one says

**Wait for a raindrop in the drought-** When someone is waiting for a raindrop in the drought, they are waiting or hoping for something that is extremely unlikely to happen

**Walking on broken glass-** When a person is punished for something

**Wet behind the ears-** Someone who is wet behind the ears is either very young or inexperienced

**Whale of a time-** If you have a whale of a time, you really enjoy yourself

**Work your fingers to the bone-** If you work your fingers to the bone, you work extremely hard on something

**Wrench in the works-** If someone puts or throws a wrench, or monkey wrench, in the works, they ruin a plan

**X factor –** The dangers for people in the military that civilians do not face, for which they receive payment, are known as the X factor.

**X marks the spot –** This is used to say where something is located or hidden.

**X-rated –** If something is x-rated, it is not suitable for children.

**Yah boo sucks-** Yah boo & yah boo sucks can be used to show that you have no sympathy with someone.

**Yank my chain -** If someone says this to another person (i.e. stop yanking my chain) it means for the other person to leave the person who said it alone and to stop bothering them.

**Yell bloody murder –** If someone yells bloody murder, they protest angrily and loudly, or scream in fear.

**Yellow press –** The yellow press is a term for the popular and sensationalist newspapers.

**Yellow streak-** If someone has a yellow streak, they are cowardly about something.

**Yellow-bellied –** A yellow-bellied person is a coward.

**Yen –** If you have a yen to do something, you have a desire to do it.

**Yeoman's service –** To do yeoman's service is to serve in an exemplary manner.

**Yes-man –** Someone who always agrees with people in authority is a yes-man.

**Yesterday's man or Yesterday's woman –** Someone, especially a politician or celebrity, whose career is over or on the decline is yesterday's man or woman.

**You are what you eat –** This is used to emphasize the importance of a good diet as a key to good health.

**You can catch more flies with honey than with vinegar –** This means that it is easier to persuade people if you use polite arguments and flattery than if you are confrontational.

**You can choose your friends, but you can't choose your family** – Some things you can choose, but others you cannot, so you have to try to make the best of what you have where you have no choice.

**You can lead a horse to water, but you can't make it drink** – This idiom means you can offer something to someone, like good advice, but you cannot make them take it.

**You can't fight City Hall** – This phrase is used when one is so cynical that one doesn't think one can change their Representatives. The phrase must have started with frustration towards a local body of government.

**You can't have cake and the topping, too** – This idiom means that you can't have everything the way you want it, especially if your desires are contradictory.

**You can't have your cake and eat it** – This idiom means that you can't have things both ways. For example, you can't have very low taxes and a high standard of state care.

**You can't hide elephants in mouse holes** – means that some issues/problems/challenges cannot be hidden/concealed but have to be faced and dealt with.

**You can't make a silk purse out of a sow's ear** – If something isn't very good to start with, you can't do much to improve it.

**You can't make an omelet without breaking eggs** – This idiom means that in order to achieve something or make progress, there are often losers in the process.

**You can't take it with you** – Enjoy life, enjoy what you have and don't worry about not having a lot, especially money...because once you're dead, 'you can't take it with you.' For some, it means to use up all you have before you die because it's no use to you afterwards.

**You can't teach an old dog new tricks** – It is difficult to make someone change the way they do something when they have been doing it the same way for a long time

**You can't un-ring a bell** – This means that once something has been done, you have to live with the consequences as it can't be undone.

**You could have knocked me down with a feather** – This idiom is used to mean that the person was very shocked or surprised.

**You do not get a dog and bark yourself** – If there is someone in a lower position who can or should do a task, then you shouldn't do it.

**You reap what you sow** – This means that if you do bad things to people, bad things will happen to you, or good things if you do good things. It is normally used when someone has done something bad.

**You scratch my back and I'll scratch yours** – This idiom means that if you do something for me, I'll return the favour.

**You're toast** – If someone tells you that you are toast, you are in a lot of trouble.

**You've got rocks in your head** – Someone who has acted with a lack of intelligence has rocks in their head.

**You've made your bed- you'll have to lie in it** – This means that someone will have to live with the consequences of their own actions.

**Young Turk** – A Young Turk is a young person who is rebellious and difficult to control in a company, team or organization.

**Your belly button is bigger than your stomach** – If your belly button is bigger than your stomach, you take on more responsibilities than you can handle.

**Your call** – If something is your call, it is up to you to make a decision on the matter.

**Your name is mud** – If someone's name is mud, then they have a bad reputation.

**Your sins will find you out** – This idiom means that things you do wrong will become known.

**Zero hour** – The time when something important is to begin is zero hour.

**Zigged before you zagged** – If you did things in the wrong order, you zigged before you zagged.

**Zip it** – This is used to tell someone to be quiet.

## CHAPTER TWO CONCORD

**Concord** refers to the agreement between the subject and verb or between different parts of a sentence in terms of number, person, gender, and tense. Below are the detailed rules of concord with examples

### I. Subject-Verb Concord (Agreement in Number and Person)

#### (a) Singular Subject Takes Singular Verb

A singular subject must take a singular verb.

**\*Examples:**

- The boy **plays** football every evening.
- She **is** very intelligent.

**\*Incorrect:**

- The boy **play** football every evening.

#### (b) Plural Subject Takes Plural Verb

A plural subject must take a plural verb.

**\*Examples:**

- The boys **play** football every evening.
- They **are** very intelligent.

**\*Incorrect:**

- The boys **plays** football every evening.

#### (c) Collective Nouns and Verb Agreement

Some collective nouns (e.g., team, family, committee) may take singular or plural verbs depending on whether they act as a unit or as individuals.

**\*Example:**

- The committee **has** decided. (acting as one unit)
- The committee **have** disagreed on the matter. (acting as individuals)

#### (d) Two Singular Subjects Joined by "And" Take a Plural Verb

When two singular subjects are joined by *and*, the verb must be plural.

**\*Example:**

- James **and** Peter **are** best friends.
- My mother **and** father **love** me.

**\*Incorrect:**

- James and Peter **is** best friends.

**Exception:**

If the two nouns refer to the same person or thing, a singular verb is used.

- Bread and butter **is** my favorite breakfast.
- My best friend and mentor **is** here.

#### (e) Singular Subjects Joined by "Or" or "Nor" Take a Singular Verb

When two singular subjects are joined by *or* or *nor*, the verb is singular.

**\*Example:**

- Neither John **nor** Mary **is** coming.
- Either my brother **or** my sister **has** taken my book.

**\*Incorrect:**

- Either my brother or my sister **have** taken my book.

#### (f) When One Subject is Singular and the Other is Plural

If one subject is singular and the other is plural, the verb agrees with the nearer subject.

**\*Example:**

- Either the teacher **or** the students **are** making noise.
- Either the students **or** the teacher **is** making noise.

**\*Incorrect:**

- Either the teacher or the students **is** making noise.

## 2. Pronoun-Antecedent Concord

The pronoun must agree with its antecedent in number, gender, and person.

**\*Example:**

- Every student must bring **his or her** book.
- The teachers gave **their** best effort.

**\*Incorrect:**

- Every student must bring **their** book. (incorrect because "every student" is singular)

### 3. Concord of Number (Singular vs. Plural Words and Expressions)

#### (a) Certain Expressions are Always Singular

Some words appear plural but take a singular verb.

**\* Example:**

- Mathematics **is** my favorite subject.
- News **is** interesting.

**\* Incorrect:**

- Mathematics **are** my favorite subject.

#### (b) Certain Expressions are Always Plural

Some words always take a plural verb.

**\* Example:**

- Scissors **are** sharp.
- The trousers **are** new.

**\* Incorrect:**

- The trousers **is** new.

### 4. Concord of Tense

Tenses must be consistent within a sentence.

**\* Example:**

- She **was** sleeping when I **arrived**.
- He **had eaten** before I **came**.

**\* Incorrect:**

- She **was** sleeping when I **arrives**.

### 5. Concord of Politeness

In formal situations, "you" is always plural, even if referring to one person.

**\* Example:**

- You **are** welcome.

**\* Incorrect:**

- You **is** welcome.

### 6. Concord of Proximity

When two subjects are joined by "or" or "nor," the verb agrees with the closer subject.

**\* Example:**

- Neither the students nor the teacher **is** in the class.
- Neither the teacher nor the students **are** in the class.

### 7. Notional Concord (Meaning Overrides Grammar)

Sometimes, a singular noun may take a plural verb if it conveys a plural idea.

**\* Example:**

- The team **are** celebrating. (if considering individuals in the team)
- The team **is** ready. (if considering the team as one unit)

### 8. Inverted Concord (When the Verb Comes Before the Subject)

When the verb comes before the subject, it still agrees in number.

**\* Example:**

- There **is** a book on the table.
- There **are** books on the table.

**\* Incorrect:**

- There **is** books on the table.

### 10. Concord of Indefinite Pronouns

Indefinite pronouns (e.g., *everyone*, *somebody*, *nobody*, *each*) are singular and take singular verbs.

**\* Examples:**

- Everybody **loves** good food.
- Someone **is** knocking at the door.

**\* Incorrect:**

- Everyone **love** good food.

- Someone **are** knocking at the door.

## 11. Concord of Titles and Names

When referring to book titles, movies, or organizations, even if they appear plural, they take a singular verb.

### \* Examples:

- "The United Nations" **is** an international body.
- "Great Expectations" **is** a novel by Charles Dickens.

### \* Incorrect:

- "The United Nations" **are** an international body.

## 12. Concord of Parenthetical Phrases

Parenthetical phrases (e.g., *as well as*, *along with*, *together with*, *in addition to*) do not affect the number of the verb. The verb agrees with the main subject.

### \* Examples:

- The teacher, along with the students, **is** attending the meeting.
- The principal, as well as the staff, **was** honored.

### \* Incorrect:

- The teacher, along with the students, **are** attending the meeting.

## 13. Concord of Fractions and Percentages

For fractions and percentages, the verb agrees with the noun following *of*.

### \* Examples:

- One-third of the cake **is** gone.
- Fifty percent of the students **are** present.
- Two-thirds of the water **has** evaporated.

### \* Incorrect:

- Fifty percent of the students **is** present.

## 14. Concord of Plural Nouns with Singular Meaning

Some plural-looking nouns (e.g., *news*, *mathematics*, *physics*, *economics*, *measles*) take a singular verb.

### \* Examples:

- Mathematics **is** difficult.
- Physics **deals** with the study of matter.

### \* Incorrect:

- Mathematics **are** difficult.

## 15. Concord of Plural Forms of Foreign Words

Some foreign words retain their plural forms but take singular verbs.

### \* Examples:

- The media **is** influencing public opinion.
- The agenda **has** been set.

### \* Incorrect:

- The media **are** influencing public opinion.

## 16. Concord of "Each" and "Every"

The words *each* and *every* are singular and require a singular verb.

Each of + plural noun + singular verb

Every + singular noun + singular verb

### \* Examples:

- Each of the boys **is** hardworking.
- Every student **has** a textbook.

### \* Incorrect:

- Each of the boys **are** hardworking.

## 17. Concord of "More than One"

The phrase *more than one* takes a singular verb.

### \* Example:

- More than one student **has** failed the test.

### \* Incorrect:

- More than one student **have** failed the test.

## 18. Concord of "A Number of" vs. "The Number of"

- *A number of* takes a **plural** verb.
- *The number of* takes a **singular** verb.

### \* Examples:

- A number of students **are** absent.
- The number of students **is** increasing.

### \* Incorrect:

- A number of students **is** absent.

## 19. Concord of "There is" vs. "There are"

- Use *there is* for singular nouns.
- Use *there are* for plural nouns.

### \* Examples:

- There **is** a book on the table.
- There **are** many books on the table.

### \* Incorrect:

- There **is** many books on the table.

## 20. Concord of "One of the"

The phrase *one of the* is followed by a plural noun but takes a singular verb.

### \* Examples:

- One of the students **is** late.
- One of the cars **was** stolen.

### \* Incorrect:

- One of the students **are** late.

## 21. Concord in Conditional Sentences

Certain conditional sentences require specific verb agreement.

### \* Examples:

- If I **were** you, I would study harder. (Subjunctive mood)
- If she **was** at home, she didn't answer the phone.

### \* Incorrect:

- If I **was** you, I would study harder.

## 22. Concord of Quantifiers with Countable and Uncountable Nouns

Some quantifiers require specific verb agreements.

### \* Examples:

- Much of the water **has** evaporated. (Uncountable noun)
- Many of the students **have** arrived. (Countable noun)

### \* Incorrect:

- Much of the water **have** evaporated.

## 23. Concord of "None"

The word *none* can take either a singular or plural verb, depending on the context.

### \* Examples:

- None of the food **is** left.
- None of the students **are** late.

### \* Incorrect:

- None of the students **is** late. (Can be correct in some cases, but "are" is preferred for plural subjects.)

## 24. Concord of "All" and "Some"

- *All* and *some* take singular verbs with uncountable nouns but plural verbs with countable nouns.

### \* Examples:

- All the water **is** contaminated.
- All the students **are** in class.
- Some of the sugar **is** missing.
- Some of the boys **are** late.

### X Incorrect:

- All the students **is** in class.

**NOTE** when "All", means everything, singular verb should be used but it means everybody plural should be used

## CHAPTER THREE THE ENGLISH SOUND SYSTEM

The **English sound system** refers to the different speech sounds (phonemes) that make up the English language. It consists of vowels, consonants, and suprasegmental features like stress, intonation, and rhythm. Below is a detailed explanation of the English sound system with examples.

## THE ENGLISH ALPHABET AND SOUNDS

The English alphabet has **26 letters**, but these letters represent **44 sounds (phonemes)** in Standard English. The sounds are divided into:

- **Vowel sounds** (20)
- **Consonant sounds** (24)

### 2. VOWEL SOUNDS (20)

Vowel sounds are produced without any obstruction of airflow in the mouth. They are divided into:

- **Monophthongs (pure vowels) – 12 sounds**
- **Diphthongs (gliding vowels) – 8 sounds**

A. In English phonetics, **monophthongs** refer to pure vowel sounds articulated with a single, unchanging mouth position. There are 12 such monophthongs in Received Pronunciation (RP) English, categorized based on tongue position and lip rounding. Below are these vowels, each accompanied by five example words and their phonetic transcriptions:

1. /i:/ (Close front unrounded vowel)

- **Examples:**
  - "see" – /si:/
  - "tree" – /tri:/
  - "machine" – /mə'ʃi:n/
  - "key" – /ki:/
  - "people" – /'pi:pəl/

2. /ɪ/ (Near-close near-front unrounded vowel)

#### • Examples:

- "sit" – /sɪt/
- "fish" – /fɪʃ/
- "busy" – /'bɪzi/
- "build" – /bɪld/
- "myth" – /mɪθ/

3. /e/ (Close-mid front unrounded vowel)

#### • Examples:

- "bed" – /bed/
- "head" – /hed/
- "said" – /sed/
- "friend" – /frend/
- "any" – /'eni/

4. /æ/ (Near-open front unrounded vowel)

#### • Examples:

- "cat" – /kæt/
- "apple" – /'æpəl/
- "man" – /mæn/
- "dance" – /dæns/
- "laugh" – /læf/

5. /ɑ:/ (Open back unrounded vowel)

#### • Examples:

- "father" – /'fɑ:ðər/
- "car" – /kɑ:r/
- "heart" – /hɑ:rt/
- "calm" – /kɑ:m/
- "palm" – /pɑ:m/

6. /ɒ/ (Open back rounded vowel)

#### • Examples:

- "dog" – /dɒg/
- "clock" – /klɒk/
- "hot" – /hɒt/
- "bottle" – /'bɒtəl/
- "coffee" – /'kɒfi/

7. /ɔ:/ (Open-mid back rounded vowel)

- **Examples:**

- "saw" – /sɔ:/
- "door" – /dɔ:/
- "law" – /lɔ:/
- "more" – /mɔ:/
- "floor" – /flɔ:/

8. /ʊ/ (Near-close near-back rounded vowel)

- **Examples:**

- "book" – /bʊk/
- "put" – /pʊt/
- "could" – /kʊd/
- "foot" – /fʊt/
- "good" – /gʊd/

9. /u:/ (Close back rounded vowel)

- **Examples:**

- "blue" – /blu:/
- "food" – /fu:d/
- "true" – /tru:/
- "moon" – /mu:n/
- "shoe" – /ʃu:/

10. /ʌ/ (Open-mid back unrounded vowel)

- **Examples:**

- "cup" – /kʌp/
- "love" – /lʌv/
- "money" – /'mʌni/
- "sun" – /sʌn/
- "blood" – /blʌd/

11. /ɜ:/ (Open-mid central unrounded vowel)

- **Examples:**

- "bird" – /bɜ:d/
- "her" – /hɜ:r/
- "nurse" – /nɜ:s/
- "word" – /wɜ:d/
- "learn" – /lɜ:n/

12. /ə/ (Open-mid central unrounded vowel)

- □ "sofa" – /'səʊfə/
- □ "banana" – /bə'nɑ:nə/
- □ "support" – /sə'pɔ:t/
- □ "problem" – /'prɒbləm/
- □ "master" – /'ma:stə/

## DIPHTHONGS

B. **Diphthongs** are complex vowel sounds that begin with one vowel and glide into another within the same syllable. There are eight primary diphthongs in English. Below are these diphthongs, each accompanied by five example words and their phonetic transcriptions:

1. /eɪ/ (as in "face" /feɪs/)

- **Examples:**

- "day" – /deɪ/
- "play" – /pleɪ/
- "say" – /seɪ/
- "weight" – /weɪt/
- "eight" – /eɪt/

2. /aɪ/ (as in

- "my" – /maɪ/
- "light" – /laɪt/
- "cry" – /kraɪ/
- "find" – /faɪnd/
- "kite" – /kaɪt/

3. /ɔɪ/ (as in

- "boy" – /bɔɪ/
- "coin" – /kɔɪn/
- "toy" – /tɔɪ/
- "voice" – /vɔɪs/
- "enjoy" – /ɪn'dʒɔɪ/

4. /aʊ/ (as in

- "now" – /naʊ/
- "house" – /haʊs/
- "about" – /ə'baʊt/
- "down" – /daʊn/
- "loud" – /laʊd/

## 5. /əʊ/ (as in

- "go" – /gəʊ/
- "show" – /ʃəʊ/
- "no" – /nəʊ/
- "home" – /həʊm/
- "boat" – /bəʊt/

## 6. /ɪə/ (as in

- "beer" – /bɪə/
- "clear" – /klɪə/
- "fear" – /fɪə/
- "idea" – /aɪˈdɪə/

## 7. /eə/ (as in

- "air" – /eə/
- "care" – /keə/
- "hair" – /heə/
- "there" – /ðeə/
- "where" – /weə/

## 8. /ʊə/ (as in

- "tour" – /tʊə/
- "sure" – /ʃʊə/
- "pure" – /pjʊə/
- "secure" – /sɪˈkjʊə/
- "endure" – /ɪnˈdjʊə/

### 3. CONSONANT SOUNDS (24)

Consonant sounds are produced when airflow is restricted or stopped in the vocal tract. They are categorized based on **place of articulation** (where the sound is made) and **manner of articulation** (how the sound is made).

#### A. PLOSIVES (STOP SOUNDS) – 6 Sounds

These sounds are produced by stopping and then releasing airflow. **Symbol Example Words** /p/ pen, pig, tap/b/ bag, big, cab/t/ top, tea, cat/d/ dog, door, bed/k/ cat, king, back/g/ go, girl, bag

#### B. FRICATIVES – 9 Sounds

These are produced by forcing air through a narrow gap. **Symbol Example Words** /f/ fan, fish, leaf/v/ van, very, love/θ/ thin, bath, teeth/ð/ this, that, brother/s/ sun, sit, face/z/ zoo, zip, bees/ʃ/ shoe, fish, ship/ʒ/ measure, vision, beige/h/ house, hat, hot ✓ **Example Sentences:**

- The **fish** is swimming. (/f/)
- He lost his **vision**. (/ʒ/)

#### C. AFFRICATES – 2 Sounds

These are a combination of plosive and fricative sounds. **Symbol Example Words** /tʃ/ church, chair, cheese/dʒ/ judge, jump, age □ **Example Sentences:**

- I sat on the **chair**. (/tʃ/)
- He is a **judge**. (/dʒ/)

#### D. NASALS – 3 Sounds

These sounds are produced by allowing air to escape through the nose.

##### Symbol Example Words

|     |                   |
|-----|-------------------|
| /m/ | man, mother, time |
| /n/ | net, nose, sun    |
| /ŋ/ | sing, long, ring  |

##### ✓ Example Sentences:

- She is singing a **song**. (/ŋ/)
- The **man** is tall. (/m/)

#### E. APPROXIMANTS – 4 Sounds

These sounds involve little obstruction of airflow.

##### Symbol Example Words

|     |                    |
|-----|--------------------|
| /w/ | win, water, window |
| /r/ | run, red, right    |
| /j/ | yes, yellow, you   |
| /l/ | lamp, love, call   |

##### ✓ Example Sentences:

- The **window** is open. (/w/)
- He **loves** chocolate. (/l/)

## CHAPTER FOUR WORD STRESS

Understanding word stress is essential for clear and accurate English pronunciation. Word stress refers to the emphasis placed on a particular syllable within a word, making it more prominent than the others. This emphasis can affect the word's meaning and its part of speech. Below is a comprehensive guide to word stress rules, accompanied by examples with their phonetic transcriptions. Each English word has only one primary stress. In longer words, there may be secondary stresses, but these are less pronounced than the primary stress. Stress is applied to **vowels** within syllables, **not consonants**.

### Word Stress Rules with Examples:

#### A. Two-Syllable Words:

- **Nouns and Adjectives:** Stress typically falls on the first syllable.
  - Examples:
    - 'PRESent' (gift) – /'prez.ənt/
    - 'SLEnDer' (thin) – /'slɛn.dər/
    - 'CLEVer' (smart) – /'klɛv.ər/
    - 'HAPpy' (joyful) – /'hæp.i/
- **Verbs and Prepositions:** Stress usually falls on the second syllable.
  - Examples:
    - 'to preSENT' (to offer) – /prɪ'zɛnt/
    - 'to exPORT' (to send goods abroad) – /ɪk'spɔ:t/
    - 'to deCIDE' (to choose) – /dɪ'saɪd/
    - 'beTWEEN' (in the middle of) – /bɪ'twi:n/

#### B. Words with Identical Spelling but Different Stress:

Some words change meaning and part of speech based on stress placement, stress as follows

- Examples:
  - 'CONtract' (noun: a binding agreement) – /'kɒn.trækt/
  - 'conTRACT' (verb: to shrink) – /kən'trækt/

- 'REcord' (noun: a documented account) – /'rɛk.ɔ:d/
- 'reCORD' (verb: to document) – /rɪ'kɔ:d/

#### C. Three-Syllable Words:

- **Words Ending in "-er" or "-ly":** Stress often falls on the first syllable.
  - Examples:
    - 'ORderly' (neat) – /'ɔ:.dər.li/
    - 'QUetly' (silently) – /'kwai.ət.li/
    - 'MAner' (supervisor) – /'mæn.ɪ.dʒər/
    - 'LOvingly' (affectionately) – /'lʌv.ɪŋ.li/
- **Words Ending in "-ic," "-sion," or "-tion":** Stress typically falls on the penultimate (second-to-last) syllable.
  - Examples:
    - 'geoGRAPHic' (related to geography) – /dʒiə'græf.ɪk/
    - 'comMISSion' (a task) – /kə'mɪʃ.ən/
    - 'creAtion' (something made) – /kri'eɪ.ʃən/
    - 'draMATIC' (theatrical) – /drə'mæt.ɪk/

#### D. Words Ending in Specific Suffixes:

Words ending with the suffixes "-cy," "-ty," "-phy," "-gy," and "-al" typically have their primary stress as follows, along with their phonetic transcriptions:

##### 1. Words Ending in "-cy":

- **"DeMOcracy"** (a system of government by the whole population) – /dɪ'mɒk.rə.si/
- **"ConSPIRacy"** (a secret plan by a group to do something unlawful) – /kən'spɪr.ə.si/
- **"BuREAUcracy"** (a system of government where decisions are made by state officials) – /bjʊə'rʊk.rə.si/
- **"ACcuracy"** (the quality of being correct) – /'æk.jʊ.rə.si/

**2. Words Ending in "-ty":**

- **"AcTiVity"** (the condition of being active) – /æk'tɪv.ɪ.ti/
- **"SensiTiVity"** (the quality of being sensitive) – /,sɛn.sɪ'tɪv.ɪ.ti/
- **"CreaTiVity"** (the use of imagination to create something) – /,kri:.eɪ'tɪv.ɪ.ti/
- **"ResponsiBiLity"** (the state of being accountable) – /rɪ,spɒn.sə'bɪl.ɪ.ti/

**3. Words Ending in "-phy":**

- **"PhoTOgraphy"** (the art of taking photographs) – /fə'tɒɡ.rə.fi/
- **"GeOGRAPHy"** (the study of Earth's physical features) – /dʒɪ'ɒɡ.rə.fi/
- **"BiOGRAPHy"** (an account of someone's life) – /baɪ'ɒɡ.rə.fi/
- **"PhiLOSophy"** (the study of fundamental nature of knowledge) – /fɪ'lɒs.ə.fi/
- **"DeMOGRAPHy"** (the study of populations) – /dɪ'mɒɡ.rə.fi/

**4. Words Ending in "-gy":**

- **"GeOLOGY"** (the science dealing with Earth's physical structure) – /dʒɪ'ɒl.ə.dʒi/
- **"BiOLOGY"** (the study of living organisms) – /baɪ'ɒl.ə.dʒi/
- **"TechNOlogy"** (the application of scientific knowledge) – /tɛk'nɒl.ə.dʒi/
- **"ECology"** (the study of interactions among organisms) – /ɪ'kɒl.ə.dʒi/
- **"TheOlogy"** (the study of the nature of God) – /θɪ'ɒl.ə.dʒi/

**5. Words Ending in "-al":**

- **"CRITical"** (expressing adverse judgments) – /'krɪt.ɪ.kəl/
- **"HisTORical"** (concerning past events) – /hɪ'stɒr.ɪ.kəl/
- **"PoLItical"** (relating to government) – /pə'lɪt.ɪ.kəl/

- **"MeMOrial"** (something designed to preserve the memory of a person) – /mə'mɔ:ri.əl/
- **"IndiVidual"** (single; separate) – /,ɪn.dɪ'vɪdʒ.u.əl/

By focusing on these stress patterns, you can enhance your pronunciation and comprehension of English words ending with these suffixes.

**E. Compound Words:**

- **Compound Nouns:** Stress is on the first syllable.
  - Examples:
    - 'BLACKbird' (a type of bird) – /'blæk.bɜ:rd/
    - 'FOOTball' (a sport) – /'fʊt.bɔl/
    - 'SUNflower' (a type of flower) – /'sʌn.flauər/
    - 'TOOTHpaste' (dental cleaner) – /'tu:θ.peɪst/
- **Compound Adjectives and Verbs:** Stress as follows.
  - Examples:
    - 'old-FASHioned' (outdated) – /,əʊld'fæʃ.ənd/
    - 'underSTAND' (comprehend) – /,ʌn.dər'stænd/
    - 'overLOOK' (miss) – /,əʊ.vər'lʊk/
    - 'outRUN' (run faster than) – /,aʊt'rʌn/

**F. Words Ending in "-ee" and "-eer":**

- **Suffixes "-ee" and "-eer":** Stress typically falls on the final or second to the last syllable.
  - Examples:
    - 'emPLOYee' (worker) – /ɪm'plɔɪ.i:/
    - 'volunTEER' (helper) – /,vɒl.ən'tɪər/
    - 'refuGEE' (displaced person) – /,rɛf.jʊ'dʒi/
    - 'engiNEER' (technical professional) – /,ɛn.dʒɪ'nɪər/

**G. Words Ending in "-ese" and "-ique":**

Words ending in "-ese" and "-ique" typically have the primary stress on the final syllable. **Words Ending in "-ese":**

1. **"Chinese"** (related to China) – /tʃaɪ'ni:z/
2. **"Portuguese"** (related to Portugal) – /,pɔ:r.tʃə'gi:z/
3. **"Vietnamese"** (related to Vietnam) – /,vjet.nə'mi:z/

4. **"Maltese"** (related to Malta) – /məˈliːtiːz/
5. **"Lebanese"** (related to Lebanon) – /ˌleɪ.bən.iːz/
6. **"Nepalese"** (related to Nepal) – /ˌnɛp.əˈliːz/
7. **"Sudanese"** (related to Sudan) – /ˌsuː.dən.iːz/
8. **"Togolese"** (related to Togo) – /ˌtoʊ.gəˈliːz/
9. **"Congolese"** (related to Congo) – /ˌkɒŋ.gəˈliːz/
10. **"Balinese"** (related to Bali) – /ˌbæ.lɪˈniːz/

### Words Ending in "-ique":

1. **"Unique"** (one of a kind) – /juˈniːk/
2. **"Antique"** (ancient or old) – /ænˈtiːk/
3. **"Boutique"** (a small shop) – /buˈtiːk/
4. **"Critique"** (a detailed analysis) – /kriˈtiːk/
5. **"Mystique"** (a mysterious quality) – /miˈstiːk/
6. **"Physique"** (the form of the body) – /fiˈziːk/
7. **"Oblique"** (slanting or indirect) – /əˈbliːk/
8. **"Technique"** (a method of doing something) – /tekˈniːk/
9. **"Monique"** (a given name) – /məʊˈniːk/

## HOW TO PRONOUNCE "S" AND "Z" IN ENGLISH

Understanding the pronunciation rules for words ending in "s" and "z" in English is essential for clear communication. The pronunciation of the final "s" can vary, typically sounding like /s/, /z/, or /ɪz/, depending on the preceding sound. Here's a detailed explanation of these rules:

### 1. Pronunciation of Final "S":

- **/s/ Sound:** When a word ends with a voiceless consonant sound (e.g., /p/, /t/, /k/, /f/, /θ/), the final "s" is pronounced as /s/.

### Examples:

- **"hats"** – /hæts/ (ends with the voiceless /t/ sound)
- **"cups"** – /kʌps/ (ends with the voiceless /p/ sound)
- **"laughs"** – /læfs/ (ends with the voiceless /f/ sound)
- **/z/ Sound:** When a word ends with a voiced sound (e.g., vowels or voiced consonants like /b/, /d/, /g/, /v/, /ð/, /m/, /n/, /ŋ/, /l/, /r/), the final "s" is pronounced as /z/.
  - Examples:
    - **"dogs"** – /dɔːgz/ (ends with the voiced /g/ sound)
    - **"beds"** – /bedz/ (ends with the voiced /d/ sound)
    - **"trees"** – /triːz/ (ends with the voiced vowel sound /iː/)
- **/ɪz/ or /əz/ Sound:** When a word ends with a sibilant sound (e.g., /s/, /z/, /ʃ/, /ʒ/, /tʃ/, /dʒ/), the final "s" is pronounced as /ɪz/ or /əz/.
  - Examples:
    - **"buses"** – /ˈbʌsɪz/ (ends with the sibilant /s/ sound)
    - **"wishes"** – /ˈwɪʃɪz/ (ends with the sibilant /ʃ/ sound)
    - **"judges"** – /ˈdʒʌdʒɪz/ (ends with the sibilant /dʒ/ sound)

### 2. Pronunciation of Final "Z":

Words ending with the letter "z" are less common in English. Typically, the final "z" is pronounced as /z/.

### Examples:

- **"buzz"** – /bʌz/
- **"fizz"** – /fɪz/
- **"jazz"** – /dʒæz/

### 3. Additional Considerations:

- **Plural Forms and Third Person Singular Verbs:** The rules above apply to plural nouns and third person singular verb forms.
    - Examples:
      - "cats" – /kæts/ (plural of "cat")
      - "runs" – /rʌnz/ (third person singular of "run")
      - "watches" – /ˈwɒtʃɪz/ (third person singular of "watch")
  - **Possessive Forms:** For singular nouns ending in "s" or "z," the possessive form is typically pronounced with an additional /ɪz/ or /əz/ and /əs/ sound.
    - Examples:
      - "boss's" – /ˈbɒsɪz/ (possessive of "boss")
      - "Liz's" – /ˈlɪzɪz/ (possessive of "Liz")
- Chris's bag /krisəs bag/  
 Alex's phone /ˈaliksəz fəʊn/

## CHAPTER FIVE

### HOW TO ANSWER COMPREHENSION PASSAGES EFFECTIVELY

Comprehension questions require careful reading, critical thinking, and an understanding of question types. Below is a step-by-step guide to answering them correctly.

#### Step 1: Read the Passage Carefully

- Read the passage slowly to understand the main idea.
- Take note of key points, arguments, and tone.
- Identify the theme (what the passage is about).

#### Step 2: Understand the Question Types

Comprehension questions often fall into the following categories:

##### 1. Main Idea/Theme Questions

- Example: **What is the passage mainly about?**
- Tip: Look at the first and last paragraphs, as they often summarize the main idea.

##### 2. Factual/Detail-Based Questions

- Example: **According to the passage, what is the role of supervisors in an examination?**
- **Tip:** Find the specific section that mentions the fact before selecting an answer.

##### 3. Inference Questions

- Example: **What can be implied from the passage?**
- **Tip:** These require logical reasoning based on what is stated, not just direct information.

**4. Vocabulary-in-Context Questions**

- Example: **What does the word "collation" mean as used in the passage?**
- **Tip:** Read the sentence containing the word and try to understand its meaning from context.

**5. Author's Tone or Purpose Questions**

- Example: **What is the author's attitude toward examination conduct?**
- **Tip:** Look for words that show emotion, approval, disapproval, or neutrality.

**Step 3: Use the Elimination Method**

- Eliminate answer choices that are clearly wrong.
- If two options seem similar, compare them to the passage for accuracy.

**Step 4: Avoid Assumptions**

- Answer based **ONLY** on what is stated or implied in the passage.
- Do not bring in outside knowledge unless the passage suggests it.

**- Step 5: Manage Your Time Wisely**

- **Spend about 5–7 minutes reading the passage and 1–2 minutes per question.**
- If stuck on a question, mark it and return later if time allows.

**Final Tips for Success**

- \* **Practice past questions** to get familiar with the pattern.
- \* **Improve your vocabulary** to understand words in context.
- \* **Stay calm** and focused during the exam.

By following these steps, you can confidently tackle comprehension passages and maximise your score!

**2023 JAMB COMPRESSION PASSAGE**

Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow:

The task of setting up an examination paper usually begins long before the examination day. Months, or even years before then, seasoned experts in various subjects are given the teaching and examination syllabuses and requested to set questions. The questions are then compiled for subsequent scrutiny. Then, a second set of experts are invited to examine the questions critically, make necessary modifications and come up with questions that conform to acceptable standards.

The result of this exercise is a set of polished and unambiguous questions that are very fair to those being examined. These questions are then securely stored.

The next stage is the registration of candidates. This stage involves not just the examining body, but also the candidates, their parents, their teachers, principals and some other members of the public. This is so because, apart from the candidates having to fill in the forms, the principal has to endorse them, while the parents have to provide the registration fees. Mistakes on the part of any of the active players at the stage of registration can have serious consequences. Next is the conduct of the examination itself. Again, more officials from outside the examination body than from within are involved at this stage. Think of the supervisors, the invigilators, and even the security officials. They are definitely more in number than the staff of the examining body. When the candidates are done with taking their examinations, a marker will carefully follow the marking scheme to score candidates accordingly. The work of the marker will further be checked by the chief examiner to ensure that candidates are graded appropriately.

The final stage is the collation of results. This is usually done using the computer to avoid collation errors as much as possible. A candidate's result may not be processed if he is involved in examination malpractice, has used a wrong examination number or has no number at all.

## QUESTIONS

1. A suitable title for the passage is.... A. stages in the conduct of an examination. B. know your examination. C. trends in the conduct of examination. D. understanding examination.
2. It can be implied from the passage that.... A. students are responsible for the poor conduct of examinations. B. the credibility and integrity of an examination is dependent on the strict adherence to the requirements of the various stages involved. C. the supervisors and invigilators play more important role in the conduct of an examination. D. all examinations must follow the same procedure.
3. One of the following is not true according to the passage. A. A combination of factors are responsible for the failure in the processing of a candidate's result. B. A candidate will perform excellently in an examination once he follows all the instructions. C. Collation of results is the final stage. D. The use of computer minimises collation errors considerably.
4. It can be inferred from the passage that the examination being discussed is.... A. more of a public examination. B. a restricted professional examination. C. a college terminal examination. D. a university-based examination.
5. The import of the above passage is to .... A. warn candidates sitting for examination. B. show that examination is a collaborative effort. C. enlighten prospective candidates on the processes involved in the conduct of examination. D. justify the reason for candidates' failure in examinations

### Explanation on the Right and Wrong Answers\*

#### 1. A – Stages in the conduct of an examination (Correct)

- **Why it is correct:** The passage systematically describes the different stages involved in conducting an examination, from setting the questions to collating results.

#### - Why others are wrong:

- **B (Know your examination)** – Too general; the passage is more about the process rather than just understanding exams.
- **C (Trends in the conduct of examination)** – The passage is not about trends or changes in examination conduct over time.
- **D (Understanding examination)** – Vague; does not capture the step-by-step process described.

#### 2. B – The credibility and integrity of an examination is dependent on the strict adherence to the requirements of the various stages involved. (Correct)

- **\*\*Why it is correct:\*\*** The passage emphasizes that each stage must be properly followed to ensure a fair and credible examination.

#### - Why others are wrong:

- **A (Students are responsible for the poor conduct of examinations)** – The passage does not blame students alone but highlights the role of all stakeholders.
- **C (Supervisors and invigilators play a more important role in the conduct of an examination)** – The passage states that many people are involved, not just supervisors and invigilators.
- **D (All examinations must follow the same procedure)** – The passage does not generalize all exams but describes a specific structured process.

#### 3. B – A candidate will perform excellently in an examination once he follows all the instructions. (Wrong)

- **Why it is wrong:** Following instructions alone does not guarantee excellent performance; preparation and understanding of the subject matter are also crucial.
- **Why the correct answer is A (A combination of factors are responsible for the failure in the processing of a candidate's result):** The passage mentions multiple factors, such as examination malpractice, wrong exam numbers, and missing numbers, which can lead to result processing issues.

**4. A – More of a public examination. (Correct)**

- **Why it is correct:** The passage describes an exam involving multiple stakeholders, similar to public exams like WAEC or UTME.
- **Why others are wrong:**
  - **B (A restricted professional examination)** – The passage does not discuss professional exams, which are usually for a specific field.
  - **C (A college terminal examination)** – The process described is more complex than a regular school or college exam.
  - **D (A university-based examination)** – University exams usually involve fewer external stakeholders compared to the process described.

**5. C – Enlighten prospective candidates on the processes involved in the conduct of examination. (Correct)**

- **Why it is correct:** The passage is structured to inform students about the different stages of an examination process.
- **Why others are wrong:**
  - **A (Warn candidates sitting for examination)** – The passage is more explanatory than a warning.
  - **B (Show that examination is a collaborative effort)** – While the passage highlights collaboration, its main purpose is to educate.
  - **D (Justify the reason for candidates' failure in examinations)** – The passage does not focus on failure but rather on the process.

**2024 JAMB COMPREHENSION PASSAGE**

**Read the passage below and answer the questions that follow:**

The room was long with windows on the right-hand side and a door at the far end that went into the dressing-room. The row of beds that mine was in faced the windows and another row, under the windows, faced the wall. If you lay on your left side you could see the dressing-room door. There was another door at the far that people sometimes came in by. If anyone were going to die they put a screen around the bed so you could not see them die but only the shoes and puttees of doctors and men nurses showed under the bottom of the

screen and sometimes at the end there would be whispering. Then the priest would come out from behind the screen and afterwards the men nurses would go back behind the screen to come out again carrying the one who was dead with a blanket over him down the corridor between the beds and someone folded the screen and took it away... When they lifted you up out of bed to carry you into the dressing - room you could look out the window and see the new graves in the garden. ( **Excerpt from A Farewell to Arms by Ernest Hemingway** )

**QUESTIONS**

1. A suitable title for the passage is.... A. Death in a Hospital Environment. B. Careers in Medicine. C. Men Dying in the Hospital. D. Graves Everywhere.
2. Which is not true according to the passage? A. Priests prayed for the departed souls in the hospital. B. The medical personnel were lackadaisical in discharging their duties. C. The patients in the hospital were not permitted to see the horror of someone leaving the world. D. The injuries and wound of patients are properly dressed and well taken care of
3. It could be inferred from the passage that ..... A. there is recognition of the role of Almighty God in the life and time of everyone. B. priest can be ignored in matters related to health C. the death of patients has no significance in a hospital environment D. the graveyard is far away from the hospital.
4. What usually brought about the whispering among the medical staff? A. Successful surgery B. Medical breakthrough C. Death of patients D. Presence of priests
5. The overall mood pervading the hospital setting was that of... A. joy and sadness. B. silence. Moodiness. D. apprehension and sadness

**Analysis of the Answer Choices****1. A suitable title for the passage is:****A. Death in a Hospital Environment (Correct)**

- The passage primarily describes death in the hospital, how patients are shielded from seeing others die, and how the dead are carried away. This makes "Death in a Hospital Environment" the most appropriate title.

**B. Careers in Medicine (Wrong)**

- The passage does not discuss medical careers, job roles, or training. It focuses on patients and death.

**C. Men Dying in the Hospital (Wrong)**

- While death occurs in the hospital, the passage does not emphasize only "men" dying. It is about death in general.

**D. Graves Everywhere (Wrong)**

- The passage mentions graves, but they are not the central focus. The main subject is how death is handled in the hospital.

**2. Which is NOT true according to the passage?****A. Priests prayed for the departed souls in the hospital. (Correct)**

- The passage states that a priest would come out from behind the screen, implying he was performing religious rites for the dying patient.

**B. The medical personnel were lackadaisical in discharging their duties. (Wrong)**

- The passage does not suggest negligence or carelessness. Instead, it shows a structured way of dealing with death, including setting up screens and carrying away the dead with dignity.

**C. The patients in the hospital were not permitted to see the horror of someone leaving the world. (Correct)**

- The screens were used to hide the dying process from other patients, which supports this statement.

**D. The injuries and wounds of patients are properly dressed and well taken care of. (Wrong)**

- The passage does not mention anything about wound dressing or

treatment, making this statement incorrect.

**3. It could be inferred from the passage that:****A. There is recognition of the role of Almighty God in the life and time of everyone. (Correct)**

- The presence of a priest suggests that religion plays a role in the hospital's approach to death, recognizing God's role in life and death.

**B. Priests can be ignored in matters related to health. (Wrong)**

- The passage shows the opposite. The priest's presence during death highlights his importance in spiritual matters.

**C. The death of patients has no significance in a hospital environment. (Wrong)**

- The structured handling of death (screens, priests, and careful removal of the dead) indicates that death is significant in the hospital environment.

**D. The graveyard is far away from the hospital. (Wrong)**

- The passage states that when lifted out of bed, patients could see new graves in the garden, meaning the graveyard is nearby.

**4. What usually brought about the whispering among the medical staff?****A. Successful surgery \* (Wrong)**

- The passage does not mention any successful surgeries, only death and its aftermath.

**B. Medical breakthrough (Wrong)**

- There is no mention of any medical discoveries or progress in the passage.

**C. Death of patients (Correct)**

- The passage explicitly states that whispering happened when someone was dying, and the priest's presence confirmed this.

**D. Presence of priests (Wrong)**

- The priest was present because of death, not the other way around. The whispering was related to patients dying, not just the priest being there.

**5. The overall mood pervading the hospital setting was that of:****A. Joy and sadness (Wrong)**

- There is no mention of joy in the passage. The entire setting is grim and somber.

**B. Silence (Wrong)**

- While there is whispering, silence is not the dominant mood. The passage describes a heavy, sorrowful atmosphere.

**C. Moodiness (Wrong)**

- "Moodiness" refers to changing emotions or irritability, which does not describe the consistent atmosphere of sadness and apprehension in the passage.

**D. Apprehension and sadness (Correct)**

- The description of screens, whispering, carrying out the dead, and seeing graves contributes to a mood of fear (apprehension) and sorrow (sadness).

### 2022 JAMB COMPREHENSION PASSAGE

The finest asset any child can have is a happy home. A happy home does not necessarily mean the one in which every member thinks, acts, feels or behaves exactly the same way, but the one in which every member stays respectfully close; ready to forgive and be there for one another; speaks kindly about to one another and support one another's big and small moments. Such environment will enable a child to develop strength and stability of character, thereby teaching him/her to face the future without fear or undue anxiety. It also will give him/her something worthwhile to live for. If the child exhibit good judgment in later years, much of the credit must go to those who trained him/her. If he/she fails, it may have been due to troubles in his/her home, school or unsympathetic or hostile relatives.

A great percentage of juvenile problems can be traced to faulty home education and unwholesome influences in early childhood. When a child is denied the benefits and the support system that a happy home offers, he/she would end up becoming a burden to the community and society at large. Undoubtedly, there would be fewer juvenile delinquents if there were more home where children learned to love and respect their fellow human beings. Remember this; happy parents create happy

homes; happy homes produce happy children; happy children make happy communities and happy communities make a happier world.

### QUESTIONS

1. A suitable title for the passage above is..... A. Child training B. Charity begins at home C. Importance of the family unit. D. Train up your children
2. In the passage, the author harps on A. The need to discipline children B. The importance of home to the to the health of the society C. Why parents should love their children unconditionally D. The evils in the society.
3. The last sentence in the passage strongly suggests that A. There is a cycle of influence between how children are raised at home and how they turned out in the society B. The society can be a better place C. Parents should take responsibility for the crisis in the society D. Children will continue to evolve in the society
4. It can be inferred from the passage that A. It is easier to build character in the formative years B. Character in adults can never be changed C. Once the home is fine, the larger society is automatically peaceful D. Love is the ultimate thing
5. According to the passage, a happy home A. Focuses on the welfare of the children B. Consists of adults that are well behaved C. Does not necessarily mean that every member behaves exactly the same D. Is full of laughter.

Here's a detailed analysis of the correct and wrong options for each question:

**Question 1: A suitable title for the passage is**

**Correct Answer: C. Importance of the family unit**

- The passage discusses the significance of a happy home in shaping individuals and society, making this the best title.

**Analysis of Wrong Options:**

- **A. Child training** – Too narrow; the passage is more about the family's role in shaping character, not just training children.
- **B. Charity begins at home** – While related, this phrase implies a

focus on moral lessons starting at home rather than the overall influence of the family unit.

- **D. Train up your children** – The passage is not just about training children but about how a supportive home environment affects society.

**Question 2: In the passage, the author harps on.**

**Correct Answer: B. The importance of home to the health of society**

- The passage emphasizes that a happy home produces well-adjusted individuals, reducing societal problems.

**Analysis of Wrong Options:**

- **A. The need to discipline children** – While discipline is important, the passage focuses on love, support, and stability, not strict discipline.
- **C. Why parents should love their children unconditionally** – Love is a key factor, but the passage emphasizes the overall impact of the home on society, not just parental love.
- **D. The evils in the society** – The passage touches on societal problems but mainly as a result of unhealthy home environments, rather than focusing on societal evils themselves.

**Question 3: The last sentence in the passage strongly suggests that.**

**Correct Answer: A. There is a cycle of influence between how children are raised at home and how they turn out in society**

- The passage concludes that happy homes create well-adjusted children, leading to a better society, which in turn fosters more happy homes.

**Analysis of Wrong Options:**

- **B. The society can be a better place** – While true, the passage specifically links societal improvement to home upbringing, making option A a more precise choice.
- **C. Parents should take responsibility for the crisis in the society** – The passage suggests parents play a role but does not blame them entirely.

- **D. Children will continue to evolve in the society** – The passage focuses on how upbringing shapes children, not just their natural evolution.

**Question 4: It can be inferred from the passage that...**

**Correct Answer: A. It is easier to build character in the formative years**

- The passage emphasizes how childhood experiences shape future behavior, indicating that character is easier to develop early.

**Analysis of Wrong Options:**

- **B. Character in adults can never be changed** – The passage does not say character is unchangeable, just that early childhood plays a significant role.
- **C. Once the home is fine, the larger society is automatically peaceful** – While a good home helps, societal peace depends on multiple factors, not just home life.
- **D. Love is the ultimate thing** – Love is important, but the passage stresses the structured support of a happy home, not just love alone.

**Question 5: According to the passage, a happy home...**

**Correct Answer: C. Does not necessarily mean that every member behaves exactly the same**

- The passage states that members of a happy home don't have to think or act the same, but they should respect and support each other.

**Analysis of Wrong Options:**

- **A. Focuses on the welfare of the children** – While children benefit from a happy home, the passage discusses the overall family dynamic, not just the children.
- **B. Consists of adults that are well-behaved** – Good behavior is important, but the passage highlights mutual respect and support rather than just behavior.
- **D. Is full of laughter** – While laughter is a sign of happiness, the passage focuses more on stability, support, and love rather than just joyful moments.